

Understanding Your Market

Who. How big. How it works. Why now.



The Mistake

“Our market is Healthcare”

The Mistake

~~"Our market is Healthcare"~~

Healthcare is an industry.
It is not your market.

What is a market?

Customer
+
Problem
+
Context / Situation

What is a market?

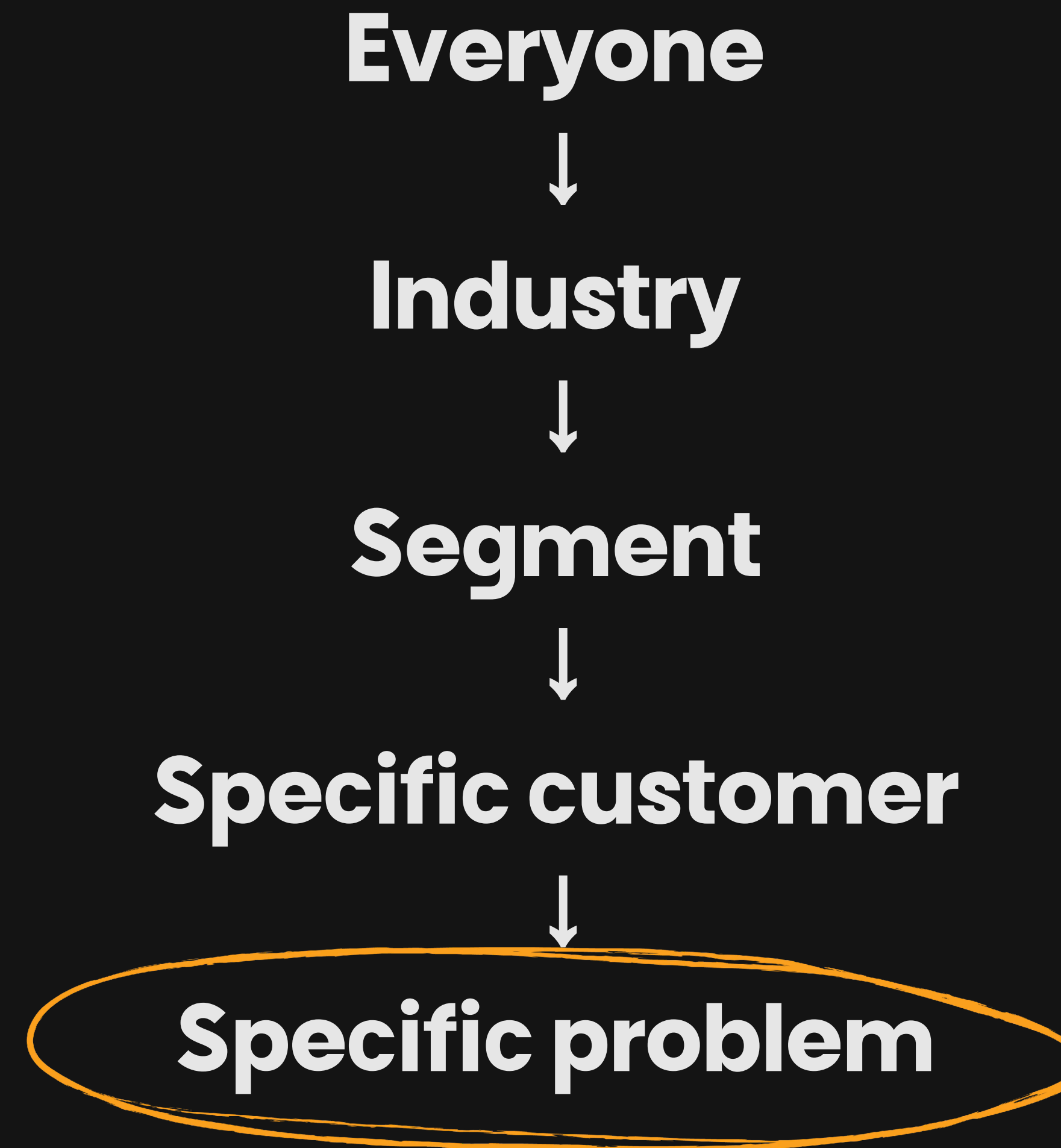
"Private clinics losing revenue because patients miss appointments"

Customer

Problem

Context / Situation

Start narrow



Find your first market

Look for customers who...

- **have a real problem**
- **have a reason to solve it now**
- **can actually buy**

Market segmentation

WHO THEY ARE

WHAT THEY NEED

HOW THEY BEHAVE

WHERE / WHEN

Segment by differences that matter.

Bad vs Useful Segmentation

Private Clinics

Too broad

vs.

- **Private dental clinics**
- **5+ dentists**
- **High number of missed appointments**

Useful

Your beachhead market



Start here:

Most serious problem

Easy to reach

High urgency

PART II: HOW BIG?

Market size



TAM

Everyone who could
theoretically buy

SAM

The market you can
actually serve

SOM

The part you could
realistically win

The \$10B market

**“The healthcare software
market is worth \$10 billion”**

So what???

Bottom-up beats top-down

Target Clinics × Annual Spend = Market size

3,000 target clinics

×

\$6,000/year

\$18M

Market size is also a reality check

Are there enough customers?

Can they pay enough?

Can I reach them at a reasonable cost?

PART III: HOW DOES THIS MARKET WORK?

Every market has rules

Markets behave differently.

User

Buyer

Where they buy

How they buy

User ≠ Buyer



What happens after the customer feels the problem?

Problem → Search → Decision → Purchase → Use

For this startup to work...

- **Clinics really lose money from no-shows**
- **The problem matters enough to fix**
- **Existing solutions are not good enough**
- **Staff will change how they work**
- **Clinics will pay for it**

These are assumptions until we have evidence

PART IV: WHY NOW?



Markets change

What is changing?

- **Technology**
- **Regulation**
- **Behaviour**
- **Economics**
- **Infrastructure**

Tailwind or headwind?

↑ What helps adoption?

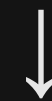
↓ What makes adoption harder?

PART V: RESEARCH

Research starts with a question

"Do private dental clinics really have a painful no-show problem?"

Search industry data



Estimate missed appointments



Calculate financial impact



Speak to clinic owners



Speak to reception staff



Evidence ladder



Your Market Map

Your Market Map

Turn your market idea into a testable market hypothesis.

Keep it specific. Write what you know, mark what you are assuming, and use the gaps to decide what to research next.

1 Customer

Who exactly are you serving?

Be specific enough that you could make a list of real people or companies.

2 Problem + situation

What problem do they have, and when / where does it happen?

Try: Customer + Problem + Context / Situation.

3 Beachhead market

Which specific segment will you start with?

Look for: serious problem + easy to reach + high urgency.

4 Market size

Is the opportunity big enough to matter?

Bottom-up: target customers x annual spend = market size.

5 How the market buys

Who uses it? Who buys? How do they search, decide and purchase?

User and buyer may be different people.

6 Why now + evidence

What is changing? What helps or blocks adoption? What do you actually know?

Separate evidence from assumptions. Write the biggest unknowns you still need to test.

NEXT: Choose your 3 biggest assumptions -> find evidence for or against them this week.

Understanding Your Market - Market Map Worksheet

Do this next

THIS WEEK

- 1. Define one customer segment**
- 2. Estimate it bottom-up**
- 3. Speak to 5–10 people**
- 4. List your biggest assumptions**
- 5. Find evidence for or against them**

The final takeaway

**Your job is not to prove yourself right.
Your job is to find out where you might be wrong.**



Thank you!

Any questions?